

GREAT SKY AI

Website Handoff Guide

Everything you need to deploy the Great Sky AI website under your own accounts and connect your domain.

PREPARED BY

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VERSION

1.0

PREVIEW

great-sky-ai.vercel.app

SECTION 01

What you are receiving

The Great Sky AI website is a **static site** - plain HTML, CSS and JavaScript. There is no database, no server-side code and no build step. This makes it fast, inexpensive to host, and simple to maintain.

Item	Details
Preview URL	great-sky-ai.vercel.app
Source code	A complete copy of the website files, ready to upload to your own GitHub account
Technology	Static HTML5, CSS3, vanilla JavaScript. No frameworks, no build step.
Pages	Home, Tech, About, Careers, News, Contact, Privacy, Terms, plus 6 news articles and 4 job listings
Fonts	STIX Two Text, Inter, Atkinson Hyperlegible Mono (loaded free via Google Fonts)
Hosting cost	Free tier available; Vercel Pro (~\$20/month) is the correct plan for commercial use

Read this first

There are **two items to complete before the site is publicly launched** (Section 02). The site is fully built and designed - but the contact form is not yet connected to an inbox, and search engines are currently blocked from indexing the site. Both are deliberate pre-launch states.

SECTION 02

Before you go live

These two items are the only things standing between the current build and a fully live website. Neither is a defect - both are deliberate pre-launch safeguards.

1. The contact and newsletter forms do not yet deliver messages

When a visitor submits the contact form or subscribes to the newsletter, they see a success message - but **the submission is not sent anywhere and is not stored**. The forms are built and styled, but not yet connected to a backend service.

Connecting a backend is a development task. Options, all with free tiers:

Option	Best for	Effort
Formspree	Fastest setup. Messages arrive by email.	~15 min
Vercel Functions	Staying entirely inside Vercel.	~1 hour
Supabase	Storing submissions in a database you own.	~2 hours

2. Search engines are currently blocked

The site sends a `noindex` instruction on every page, telling Google not to list it. This is correct while the site lives on a temporary preview URL - it stops the preview from competing with your real domain in search results.

To fix at launch: open `vercel.json`, delete the `X-Robots-Tag` line below, and redeploy.

```
{ "key": "X-Robots-Tag", "value": "noindex" }, <-- DELETE THIS LINE
```

Timing matters

Do not remove the `noindex` until **after** your real domain is connected and working. Removing it early lets Google index the temporary `.vercel.app` address, which can then compete with your real domain.

SECTION 03

Getting the site running

Follow these in order. No coding experience is required. Budget roughly 30-45 minutes, plus time for DNS to update.

Step 1 - Create a GitHub account

GitHub stores the website's code and its history. Go to **github.com** and sign up. A free account is sufficient. Use a company email address rather than a personal one, so the account can outlive any single employee.

Step 2 - Create your copy of the code

You will receive the website files as a folder. To put them into your own GitHub account:

- 1 In GitHub, click **New repository**. Name it, for example *great-sky-website*.
- 2 Set it to **Private** unless you want the code publicly visible.
- 3 Leave README, .gitignore and license unchecked.
- 4 Click **Create repository**, then choose **uploading an existing file** and drag in the contents of the *great-sky-site* folder.
- 5 Click **Commit changes**.

Step 3 - Create a Vercel account

Vercel is the hosting platform. Go to **vercel.com** and choose **Continue with GitHub** - signing in this way links the two accounts automatically, which makes the next step trivial.

A note on plans

Vercel's free Hobby plan prohibits commercial use in its terms. For a company website the **Pro plan (around \$20/month)** is the compliant choice. This site is small enough that you will not approach any usage limits.

Step 4 - Deploy

- 1 In the Vercel dashboard click **Add New, Project**.
- 2 Find your repository and click **Import**.
- 3 Leave every build setting at its default. There is no build command and no framework - if asked for a Framework Preset, choose **Other**.
- 4 If your repository contains a *great-sky-site* folder rather than the files directly, set **Root Directory** to *great-sky-site*.
- 5 Click **Deploy** and wait about a minute.

You will be given a temporary address ending in `.vercel.app`. Open it and confirm the site loads correctly before continuing to the domain setup.

SECTION 04

Connecting your domain

This points your real web address (for example *greatsky.ai*) at the site you just deployed. You will need access to wherever the domain was purchased - the **registrar** (GoDaddy, Namecheap, Cloudflare and so on).

Step 1 - Add the domain in Vercel

- 1 Open your project in Vercel, then **Settings, Domains**.
- 2 Type your domain (for example *greatsky.ai*) and click **Add**.
- 3 Vercel will display the exact DNS records to create. **Use the values Vercel shows you** - they are specific to your project and can change over time.

Step 2 - Add those records at your registrar

Log in to your registrar, find the DNS settings for the domain, and add the records Vercel gave you. They will look something like this:

Type	Name / Host	Value
A	@	(the IP address Vercel displays)
CNAME	www	cname.vercel-dns.com

The @ symbol means the domain itself (*greatsky.ai*); *www* covers *www.greatsky.ai*. Adding both means the site works either way.

Step 3 - Wait, then verify

DNS changes usually take 10 to 60 minutes, occasionally up to 48 hours. Vercel's Domains screen shows a live status and displays a valid checkmark once everything resolves. HTTPS (the padlock) is issued automatically and free - you do not need to buy an SSL certificate.

Step 4 - Turn on search engine indexing

Now that the real domain works, complete item 2 from Section 02: remove the X-Robots-Tag line from `vercel.json` and redeploy. Then submit the domain to **Google Search Console** so Google begins indexing it.

SECTION 05

Editing the site going forward

Because the site is plain HTML, edits can be made directly in GitHub's web editor without installing anything. **Every time you save a change, Vercel automatically redeploys the site within about a minute.**

Where things live

File or folder	What it controls
index.html	Home page
tech / about / careers / news / contact .html	The main interior pages
privacy.html, terms.html	Legal pages
news/	Individual news articles, one HTML file each
careers/	Individual job listings, one HTML file each
styles.css	All visual styling, colours and typography
script.js	Interactions: menu, scroll effects, form handling
assets/	All images, logos and photography
vercel.json	Hosting configuration (clean URLs, caching, security headers, noindex)

Making a simple text edit

- 1 In GitHub, open the file you want to change.
- 2 Click the pencil icon (Edit this file).
- 3 Find the text and change it. Leave anything inside angle brackets alone.
- 4 Scroll down and click **Commit changes**.
- 5 Wait about a minute, then refresh the live site.

Adding a news article or job listing

Duplicate an existing file in news/ or careers/, rename it, edit its contents, then add a link to it on the matching index page (news.html or careers.html). Matching the structure of the existing files keeps the styling consistent automatically.

If something breaks

Every change is versioned. In GitHub open the **Commits** history, find the last good version and revert to it - the site rolls back automatically. Nothing is ever permanently lost.

SECTION 06

Security and code review

A full review of the codebase was completed before handoff. Results below.

Passed

Check	Result
Secrets in source code	None. No API keys, passwords or tokens are present.
External link safety	All 88 external links use rel=noopener, preventing tab-hijacking.
Broken links	None. All internal links and image references resolve.
Image accessibility	All 92 images have descriptive alt text.
Form spam protection	Honeypot field present on the contact form.
JavaScript quality	Strict mode, no eval, no unsafe HTML injection, respects reduced-motion.
Leftover placeholders	None. No TODO or template text remains.
HTTPS	Enforced automatically, including HSTS.
Security headers	Content-Security-Policy, X-Frame-Options, X-Content-Type-Options, Referrer-Policy and Permissions-Policy are all set.
Page weight	Images optimised at handoff: total site size reduced from 19 MB to under 7 MB.

Remaining recommendations

Neither is urgent, and neither blocks launch.

Item	Detail
Content Security Policy	When you connect the contact form to a backend (Section 02), that service's domain must be added to the Content-Security-Policy in vercel.json, or submissions will be blocked. Whoever sets up the form should handle this at the same time.
Lazy loading	20 of 92 images currently load lazily. Extending this to more below-the-fold images would further improve load speed on slower connections.

SECTION 07

Launch checklist

Work top to bottom. The site is fully live once every box is ticked.

Task
☐ Create a GitHub account
☐ Upload the website files to a new repository
☐ Create a Vercel account (Pro plan for commercial use)
☐ Import the repository and deploy
☐ Confirm the temporary .vercel.app URL loads correctly
☐ Add your domain in Vercel and copy the DNS records
☐ Add the DNS records at your registrar
☐ Wait for DNS to resolve and confirm the HTTPS padlock appears
☐ Connect the contact form to a backend service
☐ Update the Content-Security-Policy to allow that service
☐ Test the contact form end to end - send a real message
☐ Remove the noindex line from vercel.json and redeploy
☐ Submit the domain to Google Search Console
☐ Optional: extend lazy loading to more images

Questions

For anything unclear in this document, or for help connecting the contact form, contact Lightsmith Design.